STATE PENSION · THE MISSING YEARS

Worked in the UK, but not in every year?

The State Pension is counted in qualifying years, not in how much you earned. A year with no National Insurance and no credits is a gap in the record. Many gaps can be paid for — not all: for time spent abroad, the rules changed on 6 April 2026.

WHAT A YEAR COSTS AT THE 2026-27 RATE

£18.40

Class 3 is **£18.40** a week in 2026 to 2027 — **£956.80** for a whole year. If you were self-employed with small profits, Class 2 is **£3.65** a week.

> You can only pay for the past **6** tax years, by 5 April. Older years are at today's rate. Class 3 for the last two years, and Class 2 for the last year, are at their own year's rate.

WHO CANNOT PAY

0 gaps

You cannot pay for a tax year with no gap — unless you get Class **3** credits and can pay Class **2**. Nor past the deadline. The test is on the tax year, not the person.

> **Usually** 10 qualifying years are needed before any is paid. EEA contributions count towards that minimum, not the amount. GOV.UK: paying "does not always increase your State Pension".

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Not sure how many years you have paid?

Message us and we will go through your National Insurance record with you. No obligation.

0330 133 1886

General information. For your own situation, speak to an accountant.